

(DLI) Scheme, highlighting 122 academic tape-outs and 16 by startups, including chips at 12-nanometre nodes. The scheme, supporting AI, IoT, and telecom chip designs, is driving India's semiconductor ambitions. The government plans to expand DLI support to 50 startups.

India's space economy grows to \$8.4 billion with 399 startups

India's space economy has surged to \$8.4 billion, with 399 startups now involved in launch vehicles, satellites, and space electronics. The growth follows 2019 reforms, including IN-SPACe, which foster private-sector participation. The sector is expected to grow 4-5 times over the next decade, with ISRO's foreign satellite launches generating substantial revenue.

C-DAC launches PRITVI-ACE chip validation facility in Bengaluru

India's C-DAC has inaugurated PRITVI-ACE, a pre-silicon validation platform in Bengaluru under the National Semiconductor Mission. Opened by MeitY Secretary S. Krishnan, the facility supports 22 technologies, enables end-to-end chip validation, and accommodates 48-core CPUs. As India's largest FPGA-based prototyping hub, it aims to cut design cycles, reduce costs, and boost semiconductor innovation.

BSNL upgrades network with 100,000 4G towers

BSNL is deploying 100,000 indigenous 4G sites across India as part of the *Aatmanirbhar Bharat* initiative, with 97,672 sites installed by mid-January 2026. The upgrade, which includes 6045 operational sites in Andhra Pradesh, ensures future 5G compatibility. This rollout has boosted BSNL's customer base from 88.6 million in March 2024 to 92.8 million by December 2025.

Raana Semiconductors raises \$3 million to build indigenous silicon ingot systems

Raana Semiconductors raised \$3 million in a seed funding round, led by Equirus Innovatex Fund and Artha Venture Fund, to develop indig-

enous silicon ingot growth systems. The funds will accelerate R&D on Czochralski monocrystalline systems for solar-grade silicon, reducing reliance on imports. The company plans to commercialise within 18 months and targets ₹2 billion in revenues by 2029.

Hisense opens first manufacturing facility in India and invests \$30 million in JV

Hisense has inaugurated its first Indian manufacturing plant at Sri City, Andhra Pradesh, through a joint venture with Epack Manufacturing Technologies. Built with a US\$30 million investment, the 10-acre facility begins commercial production of air conditioners in February 2026, later expanding to washing machines and TVs. Employing 1500 staff, it supports Make in India and export markets.

Coal India explores rare earth deals in Australia, Russia, and Africa

Coal India is exploring rare earth mining partnerships in Australia, Russia, Argentina, Chile, and Africa to reduce reliance on China. Following China's export curbs on critical minerals, Coal India is seeking both domestic and international investments, collaborating with state-owned firms like IREL. Funds from Bharat Coking Coal Ltd's \$119 million IPO will support these initiatives.

Delhi government to add 7000 EV charging points

The Delhi government will add 7000 EV charging points and 100 battery-swapping stations in 2026 to strengthen EV infrastructure. This comes ahead of the Delhi Electric Vehicle Policy 2.0, offering incentives to boost EV adoption. By the end of 2026, Delhi will have over 16,000 charging points and plans to add 1268 new battery-swapping stations.

Aimtron wins €359,000 worth European order and buys US-based ICS

Aimtron Electronics has secured a €359,000 European contract to supply box-build assemblies for automotive and industrial sectors, marking its entry into Europe. Simul-

SNIPPETS

- Tata's Dholera Fab joins SCL Mohali in chip prototype support
- Delta Electronics to expand India manufacturing footprint
- BSNL and Viasat join hands to upgrade Indian Navy SATCOM
- Telangana and US-based Blaize partner for AI and semiconductor growth
- Cornelius Electronics invests €5 million in Moldova's Edineț region
- India-EU strengthen 6G collaboration for global growth
- ABM expands semiconductor expertise with acquisition of WGNSTAR
- Silicon Labs sees 34% revenue growth in 2025
- Indian government cuts EV charger prices to boost infrastructure
- Tesla Vice President Raj Jegannathan departs after thirteen years

taneously, it acquired US-based ICS Company, strengthening its North American presence in mission-critical electronics. The deal adds US\$17 million annual revenue from 2025, scaling to US\$25 million, supporting Aimtron's ₹10 billion global growth ambition.

Vikram Solar sees 415% surge in Q3 profits

Kolkata-based Vikram Solar's Q3 2025-26 net profit surged 415%, reaching ₹980 million, driven by strong demand for solar components. Revenue rose 8% to ₹11.06 billion, while expenses fell 3%. A 9% drop in raw material costs contributed to the positive results. Despite strong performance, the stock dropped 9.65% following the report on January 20, 2026, closing at ₹214.99.

IIT Madras-backed Mindgrove unveils vision-focused SoC

IIT Madras-incubated startup Mindgrove Technologies plans to launch its V2600 system-on-chip by late 2026. Built for CCTV and surveillance, the chip integrates edge AI for video processing and decision-making. Part of the MG Vision series, it targets applications from dashcams to industrial automation, embedding hardware-level security while reducing reliance on cloud infrastructure.